



2024



Annual Report



2024



Our Voices Against Harassment

Annual Report

Message from the Executive Director

2024 has been a transformative year for Our Voices Against Harassment (OVAH). As we reflect on the milestones we have achieved, we are filled with pride and gratitude. This year marked a period of remarkable growth across all dimensions of our organization—our team, our mission, our partnerships, and most importantly, the tangible impact we have made in communities across Tanzania.

We have deepened our work, expanded our reach, and launched bold initiatives—all rooted in our unwavering commitment to end sexual and gender-based violence and to foster safer, more equitable environments for all. From schools to public spaces, from policy tables to grassroots communities, our interventions have sparked change and inspired collective action. None of this would have been possible without the generous support of our donors and champions. We extend our heartfelt appreciation to the Mastercard Foundation's Student Entrepreneurship Fund, Women Fund Tanzania, African Women's Development Fund, and to the individual donors—both within and beyond Tanzania—who continue to believe in our vision and fuel our work with their contributions.

We are also especially proud of the partnerships we have cultivated this year. The Jamii Salama Initiative stands out as a testament to what is possible when organizations come together around a shared goal. What began as an ambitious idea has grown into a powerful collaborative platform, thanks to the commitment and vision of our partners: WiLDAF, FASAT, The Launchpad Digital, C-SEMA, Tai Tanzania, Amani Initiative, and Serengeti Bytes. Each of these partners has carried the initiative with genuine ownership, transforming it into a united force for safer public spaces and community well-being.

As we close the year, we carry with us the lessons, relationships, and victories of 2024. They remind us that sustainable change is possible when we work together with purpose, courage, and heart. We look ahead to 2025 with renewed determination and an even stronger belief in the power of community-led solutions to end violence and uphold dignity for all.

In solidarity,

Modesta Joseph

Founder & Executive Director

Our Voices Against Harassment (OVAH)

Who We Are

OUR HISTORY

In 2015, at just 14 years old, Modesta Joseph launched Our Cries to stand against the physical and sexual harassment she and her fellow students faced on public transport. Determined to create change, she developed a web platform where students could report incidents. The platform collected over a thousand reports, shedding light on the issue. Our Cries installed reporting physical boxes in 20 schools across Dar es Salaam in 2016-17. Partnering with LATRA (then known as SUMATRA), Modesta raised awareness on harassment and road safety, mobilizing students, parents, and transport operators to take action. In 2020, Modesta expanded her mission by founding OVAH to combat sexual violence across Tanzania.

ABOUT OUR VOICES AGAINST HARASSMENT

Our Voices Against Harassment (OVAH) is a youth and women-led Tanzanian Non-governmental Organization dedicated to ending sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV) and promoting gender equality through awareness and advocacy, empowerment, and support



OUR VISION

To create a gender-just and violence-free nation.



OUR MISSION

To ensure the protection of children, youth, and women by combating sexual violence and empowering them to realize their rights and full potential.

OUR VALUES

1

SOCIAL JUSTICE

Social justice lies at the heart of our mission. We strive for a Tanzania where every individual, regardless of their background, is treated with dignity, respect, and fairness. We work to eliminate systemic barriers and ensure equitable access to opportunities, resources, and basic human rights for all especially girls, women and youths. By advocating for social and economic justice, we aim to create a society where everyone has the opportunity to reach their full potential, free from violence and discrimination.

2

PARTICIPATION AND LEADERSHIP

At OVAH, we believe that those who benefit from our programs are also the key drivers of their success. We prioritize the active participation of our beneficiaries in the design, implementation, and evaluation of our initiatives. By empowering those we serve to take leadership roles, we ensure that our interventions are both relevant and effective in addressing their unique needs and aspirations.

3

LEARNING AND COLLABORATION

Our work is rooted in continuous learning and growth. We embrace the opportunity to learn not only about the complex issues we tackle but also about the communities we serve, the intersectionalities of those issues, and how to evolve our approaches. At OVAH, we also believe in the power of collaboration—working together with other stakeholders to amplify our impact and foster lasting change. Through knowledge-sharing and partnership, we achieve more than we could alone.

4

IMPACT AND INNOVATION

We are committed to addressing sexual and gender-based violence in Tanzania through innovative solutions that create tangible, lasting change. Our projects are designed to be both impactful and measurable, ensuring they lead to meaningful progress. We continuously evaluate and refine our strategies, incorporating new ideas and approaches that maximize our social impact. Innovation drives us, but our focus remains on delivering real outcomes that improve the lives of those in our communities.

5

COLLECTIVE CARE

We understand that a thriving community is built on the well-being of its members. This extends to our team—board members, staff, ambassadors, and volunteers—as well as the communities we serve. We prioritize empathy, compassion, and mutual respect, fostering a culture where we listen, understand, and support one another. We believe in the power of collective care and recognize that by caring for each other, we create stronger, healthier communities.



Focus Areas (Thematic Areas)



Sexual and Gender-based Violence



Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment



Adolescents, Youth and Women Engagement and Leadership



Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights

SDGs

5 GENDER
EQUALITY



3 GOOD HEALTH
AND WELL-BEING



8 DECENT WORK AND
ECONOMIC GROWTH



10 REDUCED
INEQUALITIES



16 PEACE, JUSTICE
AND STRONG
INSTITUTIONS



Stories of Change



**Denis Edga -
Empowering minds**

Denis Edga, a 15-year-old student from Urafiki Secondary, initially believed that girls and women who wore short or revealing clothes were provoking violence against themselves. This perspective began to shift after Denis attended weekly **Empowering Minds sessions** for three months, focused on addressing sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV).

In the first session, Denis confidently asked, ***“If a girl dresses in a miniskirt and then gets sexually harassed, who is to blame?”*** Facilitators explained that clothing never implies consent and that every individual has the right to safety and respect, regardless of appearance. Despite this explanation, Denis continued to challenge these ideas, asking about situations where girls deliberately wear revealing clothing. Using examples from cultures with strict dress codes where harassment still occurs, facilitators emphasized that abuse is never the victim’s fault and that victim-blaming is harmful.

During another session, Denis raised a sensitive issue, sharing that in some families, abuse is blamed on the victim, particularly children. He asked, ***“What do you think about people blaming the child instead of the uncle in such cases?”*** Facilitators firmly stated that responsibility always lies with the abuser, not the victim, and that such beliefs perpetuate harmful norms. They encouraged Denis to critically evaluate these attitudes and advocate for respect, consent, and accountability.

By the final session, Denis had undergone a significant transformation. Reflecting on his journey, he shared:

“These training sessions have shown me that no matter what happens to you as a victim, you should not hesitate to speak up. It’s important to share your experiences with people you trust.”

Denis also recognized the norm of linking clothing to harassment, saying:

“I’ve learned that all clothes are the same, and no matter how a person dresses, it does not give anyone the right to harass or abuse them.”

Denis’s testimony is a powerful reminder of the importance of engaging young people in conversations about respect and equality. His shift in perspective not only reflects personal growth but also sets an example for his peers, contributing to a culture of accountability and safety for all.

Stories of Change



Miss Lilian - Support Services

In June 2024, Lilian faced a cyber harassment case , when a man who had been a client at her workplace threatened to release explicit videos of her online unless she agreed to meet him. This case underscores why OVAH's work in providing support services is critical. In Tanzania, countless women and girls face sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV) daily. Cyber harassment, in particular, has emerged as a growing threat, targeting young women in their most vulnerable moments.

Lilian discovered OVAH through a friend who had seen one of our Instagram posts about available spots for counseling , which highlights reporting channels and support services for GBV victims. Despite her overwhelming fear and embarrassment, she made the courageous decision to reach out. From her first contact, OVAH's psychologist created a safe, non-judgmental space where she could share her story, reassuring her that she was not alone and that the blame rested entirely on the perpetrator.

Through the Jamii Salama Initiative, OVAH partnered with Launch Pad, an organization specializing in cybercrime and digital safety. Together, we connected Lilian with cyber experts who provided legal guidance and actionable steps to address the harassment. These experts worked tirelessly to safeguard her digital identity and ensure her rights were protected. Due to her intense work schedule it was hard to have a face to face interaction with the psychologist, however Lilian received a series of counseling sessions via phone to help her process the emotional toll of the harassment and rebuild her confidence.

After days of follow-ups and counseling, the threats were neutralized. Now she has returned to her job, stronger and more careful than ever. Through cases like Lilian's, OVAH reaffirms its mission to create a safer, more equitable society for women and girls. The support provided under the Jamii Salama Initiative and partnerships like Launch Pad showcases the transformative impact of collective action. When survivors like Lilian find the courage to reach out.

Stories of Change



**Madam Khadija -
Teachers to Mentors**



“Before we attended the Teachers to Mentors training, many of us didn't have the skills to recognize or address signs of sexual and gender-based violence among our students. We were often unsure of how to intervene effectively or collaborate with others to resolve such cases.

But during the training, we learned how to identify students who might be at risk and how to respond in ways that could truly make a difference. I'll give you an example, there was this male student at our school who had very poor attendance. At first, no one could understand why. Using what I learned in the training, I decided to dig deeper. After speaking with some of his classmates, we uncovered something shocking. This young boy was living with a much older woman, almost as if they were in a marital relationship.

Without the training, I wouldn't have known what to do next. But this time, I knew exactly who to involve. I worked with the local authorities, and together, we intervened. The woman was arrested, and the boy was safely returned to school. It didn't stop there. Thanks to the counseling strategies we were taught, I was able to support him emotionally, which improved not only his attendance but also his academic performance.

This experience made me realize how much this program has transformed us as teachers. It's not just about the students, it's about empowering us to act as mentors, collaborators with parents, and bridges to the community. The student is now thriving, and his family has been positively impacted. For me, this program proved how essential it is to equip teachers with the tools to protect and support our students.”

Stories of Change



Madam Eda - Teachers to Mentors



Before the training, I often found myself supporting students in legal cases, but it wasn't easy. I didn't always know the right steps to take, and there were times I faced threats from parents who were unhappy with my involvement. It was overwhelming and, honestly, intimidating.

During the training, Ms. Veronika Buchumi gave us practical advice that changed everything. She emphasized the importance of following proper legal channels not just to protect the students but also to safeguard ourselves as teachers. Her guidance showed me that seeking justice doesn't have to come at the cost of our safety. Recently, I handled a rape and sodomy case involving two students, aged 12 and 13.

This time, I made sure to involve all the key stakeholders including parents, the police desk, and even reached out to OVAH for support. It wasn't easy, but I was motivated to ensure justice for these children. Knowing I had a clear process to follow and support from other professionals gave me the courage to see the case through. And for me, this program has bridged the gap between schools and the legal system, making it possible to protect our students without compromising our own safety.



Projects in 2024

SAFETYETU : EMPOWERMENT SELF DEFENSE TRAINING FOR ADOLESCENT GIRLS AND BOYS

The year 2024 has been a remarkable milestone for OVAH's partnership with Eng. Juliana Marko, an ESD (Empowerment Self-Defense) trainer from ESD-Global. Together, we have made significant progress in promoting the Safety Yetu program. This program aimed at personal safety and self-defense awareness among youth in Dar es Salaam. Through SafetYetu sessions, we reached 367 participants, 75% being young girls and women aged 12-20. These training sessions were held across various schools and boot camps in Dar es Salaam. Upendo Jackson, from Mnazi Mmoja Secondary School, expressed her enthusiasm for the program, saying,

"These sessions have awakened me to the effective ways to safeguard myself. I can't wait to empower my friends on the ways to protect ourselves in dangerous situations that might lead us to be subjected to sexual harassment."

Her words emphasized the transformative impact of these training sessions that we have had on participants, equipping them with practical tools to navigate and mitigate risks in their daily lives.

The SafetYetu training aimed to impart a comprehensive understanding of personal safety, emphasizing both theoretical and practical aspects. Participants were taught essential skills such as situational awareness, assertiveness, verbal confrontation, and physical self-defense techniques. These tools are designed to empower individuals to protect themselves in threatening situations, thus reducing their vulnerability to sexual harassment and other forms of violence.



367

YOUTH REACHED DURING SAFETY
YETU PROGRAM IN DAR ES SALAAM.

↑ 75%

BEING YOUNG GIRLS AND
WOMEN AGED 12-20

Projects in 2024

SAFETYETU : EMPOWERMENT SELF DEFENSE TRAINING FOR ADOLESCENT GIRLS AND BOYS



Islam Fadhili, another participant, highlighted the impact of the training, stating,

“Engaging with Safety Yetu has provided me with a renewed outlook on personal safety, and I came to realize that my body is also a potential tool against threats.”

This powerful realization reflects the program's success in instilling confidence and a sense of agency among participants.



The SafetYetu training focused on essential skills such as situational awareness, assertiveness, and physical self-defense, empowering participants to better navigate potentially dangerous situations. Eng. Juliana highlighted the importance of keen observation and risk assessment, enabling individuals to recognize threats before they escalate. Participants learned to communicate assertively, using verbal strategies to set boundaries and address uncomfortable encounters confidently. The practical self-defense techniques tools were designed to empower individuals to protect themselves in threatening situations, thus reducing their vulnerability to sexual harassment and other forms of violence. By including young girls and women, the SafetYetu training aims to foster a generation that feels empowered to advocate for their safety and that of others in their communities.

Projects in 2024

EMPOWERING MINDS PROGRAM IN SCHOOLS

From April to July 2024, OVAH implemented the Empowering Minds project in seven secondary schools across Kinondoni and Ubungo municipalities in Dar es Salaam. The project aimed to educate students about recognizing various forms of Sexual and Gender-Based Violence (SGBV), provide guidance on reporting incidents, and encourage survivors to seek support. Through interactive workshops, the program also challenged deeply rooted gender and social norms that perpetuate violence, fostering a shift in mindsets and behaviors toward gender equality. By maintaining a participation ratio of 25% male and 75% female, the sessions created an inclusive and supportive environment to actively combat sexual violence.



A total of 442 students, including 308 females and 134 males, participated in the training over three months. The sessions provided valuable insights into different forms of SGBV, psychological support, and Empowerment Self-Defense training. In August, the project concluded with the SafetYetu Empowerment Self-Defense Training, where participants learned essential skills such as assertiveness, verbal confrontation, and physical techniques to prevent, resist, and escape violent situations. The training empowered students to speak openly, seek help, and take proactive steps in addressing SGBV. One participant, Judith Ipiana from Urafiki Secondary School, shared, ***“When my friend experienced such an incident, I wondered what I would do if it were me. Thanks to the training from OVAH, I gained the courage to speak openly with trusted people, fight for my rights, and support survivors of gender-based or sexual violence. I now understand where and how to report such cases so legal action can be taken.”***

Projects in 2024

EMPOWERING MINDS PROGRAM IN SCHOOLS

Building on the success of this project, OVAH plans to continue empowering adolescent students by equipping them with the knowledge, skills, and confidence to identify and prevent sexual violence, seek support, and contribute to transforming schools into safe spaces. Through the implementation of long-term strategies, OVAH strives to create environments that actively combat sexual violence and promote gender equality within schools and the broader community

ELIMIKA NA MWAJUMA: CHAMPIONING FOR SAFE INSTITUTIONS



To understand the impact of the Elimika na Mwajuma project, it is important to recognize the challenges faced by schools in addressing Sexual and Gender Based Violence cases. Many teachers lacked the skills and tools needed to support students dealing with trauma and sensitive cases. Stigma surrounding SGBV often discouraged students from seeking help, leaving them vulnerable and unsupported. The Elimika na Mwajuma: Championing for Safe Institutions (Schools) project aims to create safer school environments by transforming teachers into mentors who can effectively support students, handle cases by providing guidance and counseling to students who are facing challenges including victims of sexual and gender based violence or at risk. OVAH trained 10 teachers from Kwembe, Mnazi Mmoja, Tandika, Kivule, and Mashujaa Secondary Schools, and equipped them with the skills to handle SGBV cases by providing guidance and counseling to students, and legal support referrals. Throughout the program OVAH involved both teachers and students in various activities such as storytelling competitions which enhanced the awareness and action against Sexual and Gender Based Violence.

Projects in 2024

ELIMIKA NA MWAJUMA: CHAMPIONING FOR SAFE INSTITUTIONS

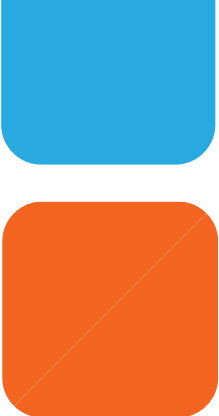
ACTIVITIES IMPLEMENTED

Capacity Building of Teachers to Respond to GBV Cases and Provide Counseling Activity

From September 4th to 6th, 2024, OVAH conducted a three-day capacity-building workshop for 10 teachers representing five schools: Kwembe, Mnazi Mmoja, Tandika, Kivule, and Mashujaa Secondary Schools. The primary objective was to enhance teachers' understanding of sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV), guidance and counseling, and reporting frameworks, equipping them to serve as mentors and provide essential support and resources to students.

The sessions were facilitated by OVAH in collaboration with partner organizations, including WILDAF and Sheria Kiganjani. These organizations delivered insightful training on legal frameworks and reporting mechanisms, equipping participants with tools such as the Funguka app, Sheria Kiganjani platform, toll-free numbers, and other legal channels for reporting abuse. Teachers were also trained on evidence collection and best practices for engaging with authorities. The workshop emphasized the teachers' duty of care, ethical responsibilities, confidentiality, and the importance of securing consent when handling sensitive information.

Projects in 2024



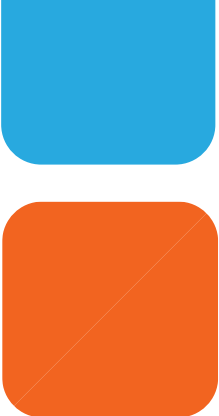
To aid in their mentorship roles, OVAH introduced the “Student Support and Mentorship Registry,” a tool designed for documenting key details about students they mentor, support, or refer for further assistance. The training adopted interactive methods, fostering a safe and open environment that encouraged participants to share experiences and insights.

By the end of the workshop, teachers demonstrated increased awareness of SGBV and a clear understanding of their responsibilities within the program. They expressed strong commitment to implementing their newfound knowledge and providing robust support systems in their schools. All 10 teachers pledged to establish SGBV Committees in their institutions, offering students safe platforms to report abuse. They also showcased a solid grasp of child protection laws, recognizing signs of abuse, and adopting gender-sensitive approaches to foster safer school environments.

This activity was a cornerstone for OVAH’s mission, addressing the critical gap in access to counseling services within schools. By empowering teachers as mentors and trusted advisors, the program aims to create a supportive network that guides, protects, and uplifts students, ensuring they thrive in a secure learning environment.



Projects in 2024



Storytelling Workshop Training for Elimika Champions

In 2023, OVAH engaged 1,115 students through the “Elimika na Mwajuma” project. From this cohort, 25 students from Tandika, Mashujaa, Mnazi Mmoja, Kivule, and Kwembe Secondary Schools were selected to participate in a storytelling and creative writing workshop. The primary objective was to equip these students with fundamental storytelling techniques, enabling them to articulate personal and community experiences related to gender-based violence (GBV) and inspire positive change through their narratives.

The workshop took place on September 27, 2024, and focused on enhancing students’ creative writing skills while raising awareness about the “Elimika an Mwajuma” animation series and its powerful community message. Ally Baharoon, a writer from Ubongo Kids, facilitated the session, equipping students with tools and techniques to craft compelling stories. This training provided a platform for students to creatively express their ideas and perspectives on GBV, empowerment, and social change, while promoting gender equality and fostering positive behavior change in their schools and communities.

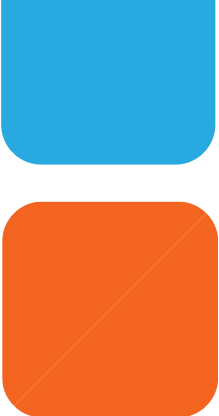
During the session, the OVAH team shared the inspiration behind the character Mwajuma, the central figure of the animation series. Mwajuma symbolizes the experiences of many girls in the community who are survivors of sexual and gender-based violence. Key themes such as rape, grooming, and victim-blaming were explored to ensure students understood the importance of these issues and how to convey them effectively in their stories. The workshop also emphasized the role of teachers, mentored by OVAH, in providing guidance and counseling to support survivors of GBV.

The training deepened students’ understanding of the “Elimika na Mwajuma” and “Mwajuma Simama” animation series, sharpening their creative writing skills for the upcoming storytelling competition. Students collectively selected sexual harassment as the central theme for their stories and left the session inspired to share their experiences with peers and work on their assignments. Through interactive screenings and discussions facilitated by OVAH, participants gained a comprehensive understanding of GBV, including its various forms, their personal experiences, and its broader impact on individuals and communities.

This process not only empowered students to become advocates for change within their schools and communities but also strengthened their ability to use storytelling as a transformative tool to raise awareness, foster empathy, and inspire action against GBV.



Projects in 2024



Elimika na Mwajuma Storytelling Competition to Commemorate the International Day of the Girl Child

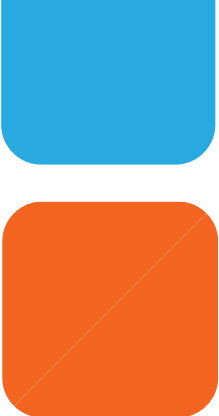
On October 12, 2024, OVAH celebrated the International Day of the Girl Child with a storytelling award ceremony and dialogue centered on this year's theme, "Girls' Vision for the Future." The theme highlighted the urgent need to address global challenges disproportionately affecting girls, including climate change, conflict, poverty, and setbacks in gender equality, while celebrating their resilience and vision for a brighter future.

OVAH hosted an engaging storytelling pitch competition where students shared personal experiences of sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV) and proposed solutions to these challenges. Trained in creative writing and storytelling, the students presented their stories before judges, teachers, OVAH staff, and distinguished guests. This activity aimed to co-create actionable solutions while inspiring participants through peer and expert interactions.

Two external judges, Lubacha Deus, a published writer, editor, and translator, and Faith Mkony, a psychologist and communications officer at C-Sema, evaluated the students' performances. Faith's expertise spans child protection, GBV, mental health, prevention of sexual exploitation and abuse (PSEA), and sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR), bringing valuable insights to the judging process.



Projects in 2024



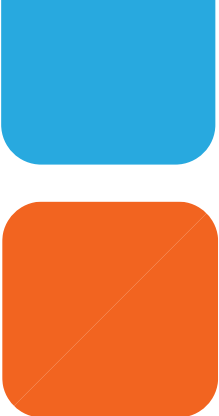
Mashujaa Secondary School emerged victorious in the “Elimika na Mwajuma” Storytelling Competition. Their compelling narrative and impactful message earned them the honor of having their story featured in the next episode of the animation series.

The event also featured a panel discussion moderated by Ms. Irene Mara, exploring the question: “How Can Girls Lead the Fight Toward Gender Equality in Tanzania?” OVAH brought together 25 students who participated in the storytelling competition, 10 teachers, guest speakers, media representatives, and two student panelists, Hadija Ulaya and Baraka Ramadhani, who voiced their peers’ perspectives during the discussion.

This activity was a celebration of the resilience, potential, and leadership of girls, providing a platform for envisioning a future where their rights are upheld, and their voices are heard. The dialogue sparked thoughtful exchanges about gender equality, with participants reflecting on the pivotal role of girls in driving societal change and promoting gender equality in Tanzania.



Projects in 2024

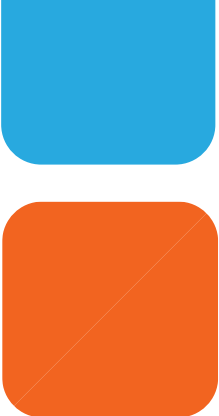


A standout moment was when the moderator, Ms. Irene Mara, encouraged attendees to write letters to their future selves, imagining their lives 10 years from now. Students and guests shared their letters, expressing aspirations for a more just and equitable world. This exercise fostered deep personal reflection and reinforced the belief that today's girls are tomorrow's leaders in the fight for gender equality.

The guest of honor, Annabahati Mlay, delivered a powerful speech emphasizing the collective responsibility to create safer, violence-free spaces for girls and children. Annabahati, a dedicated advocate for ending violence and harassment, highlighted her work in raising awareness, stakeholder engagement, and advocating for the ratification of ILO Convention 190, which addresses violence and harassment in the workplace.



Projects in 2024



Animation development and dissemination

Starting in October 2024, OVAH worked on enhancing the script originally developed by students from Mashujaa Secondary School, which focused on the theme of sexual harassment. Once finalized, the script was handed over to Tai Studios, the contracted animators, who brought it to life through a compelling video animation.

This episode, centered on sexual harassment, addressed a pervasive form of violence that is often overlooked in the community. It sheds light on the experiences of women, girls, and children who frequently face sexual harassment, highlighting how society tends to normalize or ignore these issues. The episode aimed to spark meaningful conversations, challenge societal attitudes, and shift mindsets around this critical topic.

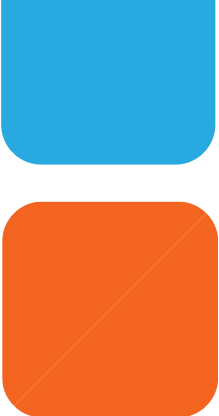
The animation reached approximately 158 women, girls, and university students during dissemination activities held on December 5th and 6th, 2024. It was shared with two key groups: women from the Amka Mama Foundation and adolescents and youth from Ardh University.

Through these engagements, OVAH sought to foster awareness, inspire dialogue, and empower participants to take a stand against sexual harassment in their communities.

Animation shared with women from Amka Mama Foundation and youth from Arthi University



Projects in 2024



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Projects in 2024

ADVOCACY AND MOVEMENT BUILDING

JAMII SALAMA INITIATIVE

Sexual harassment is alarmingly prevalent worldwide, and Tanzania is no exception. Women and girls in Tanzania face daily incidents of catcalling, inappropriate touching, and other forms of harassment, with public spaces especially public transit serving as major hotspots for such violations. A 2022 study on sexual harassment in public transport among female university students in Dar es Salaam revealed an 88% prevalence, with verbal harassment being the most reported form (95%). Despite legal protections under the Sexual Offenses Special Provisions Act (1998) and the Employment and Labour Relations Act (2004), enforcement remains a significant challenge. The perception of these incidents as harmless or minor perpetuates a culture that enables sexual abuse and exploitation.

In response to this, OVAH has created the Jamii Salama Initiative (JSI). The JSI is a collaborative effort between women's rights organizations and key stakeholders in Tanzania. Its mission is to create safer public spaces by challenging the normalization of sexual harassment, changing mindsets and attitudes, and advocating for policies that protect and empower women and girls. The initiative's main objective is to end sexual harassment against women and children in public spaces, both in Tanzania and beyond.

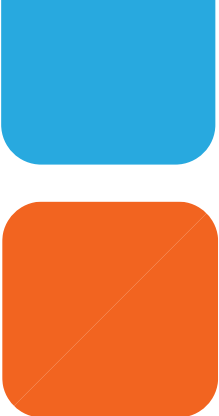
The Jamii Salama Initiative is a partnership between OVAH, Amani Initiative, FASAT, C-SEMA, TAI, Serengeti Bytes, and Launchpad Digital. Each partner brings unique expertise and resources that are crucial to the success of JSI's mission. Together, we are committed to fostering safer, more inclusive communities.

ACTIVITIES CONDUCTED

THE LAUNCH OF THE JAMII SALAMA INITIATIVE

On November 15th, the Jamii Salama Initiative (JSI) was officially launched in a public event designed to introduce the initiative and its mission to key stakeholders. The evening brought together guests from partner organizations, networks, and media groups, symbolizing a united commitment to combating sexual harassment and creating safer public spaces.

Projects in 2024



The program commenced with opening remarks from representatives of partner organizations, followed by an official introduction to JSI. Keynote speeches were delivered by Modesta Joseph, CEO of OVAH, and Mr. Gureni Ikamba, a representative from JCDecaux Tanzania, one of JSI's sponsors.

A panel discussion titled "Creating Safer Cities: Addressing Sexual Harassment and Redefining Public Spaces for Women's Safety and Inclusion" provided a platform for meaningful dialogue on solutions for combating sexual harassment in public spaces and highlighted JSI's vision for a safer society. The program continued with the screening of the JSI documentary, offering a compelling overview of the issue, the necessity of this initiative, and its planned interventions.

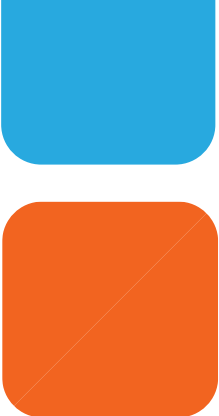
The evening concluded with a short fundraising session where attendees made pledges of financial and in-kind support to further the initiative's mission. JSI also received public exposure through media interviews conducted during the event, effectively introducing our work to a broader audience.

The success of the launch was evident in the strong participation of sponsors, partners, and the CEO, as well as the enthusiastic engagement from attendees. The event showcased a unified effort to address sexual harassment and lay the foundation for impactful action through JSI.

OUTREACH ACTIVITIES



Projects in 2024



JAMII SALAMA INITIATIVE DOCUMENTARY

As part of its commitment to raising awareness and promoting safer public spaces, the Jamii Salama Initiative (JSI) has produced a documentary alongside other video advocacy content. The documentary sheds light on the pervasive issue of sexual harassment, the urgent need for initiatives like JSI, and the steps JSI is taking to address this problem. It serves as an advocacy tool to educate the public and inspire action against sexual harassment.

In addition to the documentary, JSI has developed a series of advocacy videos (90% of its visual content) complemented by materials such as posters. These videos cover essential topics, including the prevalence of harassment, the importance of consent, and practical ways to create safe spaces for women and children across Tanzania. Through these efforts, JSI aims to spark dialogue, shift attitudes, and foster accountability in public spaces.

Moving forward, the Jamii Salama Initiative (JSI) is committed to sustaining momentum by expanding its outreach, advocacy, and engagement efforts. Future plans include scaling awareness campaigns to additional public spaces and areas, fostering stronger partnerships with government institutions, private sector players, and community-based organizations to enhance impact. We look forward to laying a strong foundation to completely eliminate sexual harassment.



Projects in 2024

THE ORANGE TABLE SERIES

Throughout the months of February and March, we addressed critical issues impacting Tanzanian youth through our monthly episodes of the Orange Table Series. We explored intimate partner violence (IPV), emphasizing early intervention and community support. In the realm of online safety, we focused on digital literacy, parental guidance, and reporting mechanisms. Additionally, we tackled the persistence of sexual harassment in public spaces, advocating for awareness campaigns, youth engagement, and collective action. Our call to action includes staying informed, educating others, advocating for safer spaces, and being allies. If you or someone you know needs a safe and confidential space to share experiences and knowledge, The Orange Table Series is here for you.

Mental health is a basic human right. According to World Health Organization WHO, Mental health is defined as a state of mental well-being that enables people to cope with the stresses of life, realize their abilities, learn well and work well, and contribute to their community. When considering Survivors of Sexual and Gender-based Violence, Mental health takes on even greater significance due to the profound impact these experiences have on their well-being. Survivors are at an increased risk for depression, anxiety, substance misuse disorders, post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), and even suicide attempts. The trauma they endure can disrupt their emotional equilibrium, leaving lasting scars.

With survivors of Sexual Gender-based Violence (SGBV) at the heart of our programs, on Friday, May 31st, we hosted an impactful episode of the Orange Table Series. In this episode, we focused on supporting the mental well-being of Survivors of Sexual Violence. We invited a group of expert mental health aiders, psychologists, and therapists to join us in an Instagram Live session. Together, we aimed to unravel and break the chains of silence and stigma associated with seeking and providing mental health support.

We asked our speakers; How can we support the Mental well-being of survivors of Sexual Violence?

Projects in 2024

RESPONSE AND SUPPORT

SUPPORT SERVICES PROVISION IN 2024

This year, OVAH has been at the forefront of providing psychological support to survivors of sexual and gender-based violence, particularly sexual harassment. We have integrated this support into every program we have worked on, from empowering minds, teachers to mentor programs, as well as the Jamii Salama Initiative.

We have handled six significant cases, including sexual harassment, violence against children, child marriage, domestic abuse, and revenge porn. We have provided guidance, counseling, and legal referrals to over 20 students.

To raise awareness, we have utilized various educational materials such as posters, billboards, banners, flyers, and social media platforms. This allows our followers to see the available spots for counseling sessions. We have also cultivated impactful partnerships with stakeholders such as school teachers from 5 secondary schools who provide guidance and counseling to students, and organizations like Launch Pad Digital, C-sema, and WiLDAF, to strengthen our support network.

Currently, we are focused on promoting a culture of reporting. We have done this in schools and public spaces, such as bus stations, where we have placed our posters encouraging reporting. Our aim is to inspire community members to support those who have experienced sexual violence by encouraging them to seek help from OVAH. We continue to strive to create a safe, supportive environment where all survivors feel empowered and heard on their journey to healing.

Testimony from a case we received in July:

"I have been facing sexual harassment, including being touched, grabbed, and called inappropriate names, to the point that it affected the way I dressed, my confidence, and my academic performance. The support I received from OVAH through counseling sessions and Empowerment Self-Defense training has boosted my confidence and helped me manage my anxiety and trauma. I feel stronger and freer because now I know what to do when a man approaches me in a way that makes me uncomfortable," says Johnnel Regina, a 19-year-old survivor of sexual harassment.

Testimonies

3 IMPACT QUOTES - JAMII SALAMA INITIATIVE

Mimi mchumba, naita sana. Hapa kijiweni, asilimia 90 ya muda tukimuona mdada akipita lazima tumuite 'mchumba.' Lakini kusema ukweli, nikifikiria kama ingekuwa mdogo wangu, nisingefurahi. Nilidhani wanachukulia poa tu, sikuwahi kufikiria kama inawaathiri. Halafu, ukiangalia, sisi wenyewe hatupati faida yoyote kwa kuwaita majina hayo. Tutajitahidi kupunguza."

Ramadhani, Mtaa wa Hidaya

(Translation: "I'm guilty of catcalling and using the term 'girlfriend' frequently. Here at the corner, 90% of the time we see a woman passing, we call her 'girlfriend.' But honestly, when I think about it as if it were my younger sister, I wouldn't like it. I thought women were okay with it, I never considered it might affect them. And when you think about it, we don't gain anything from calling them these names. We will make an effort to stop.")

Mimi huwa nahakikisha watu wanakaa kwenye mistari mwili kupeana migongo, nikiona mtu anamgeukia mtu mwingine au akifanya tabia za hovyoy. Mimi na kondakta wangu tunawashusha kuna siku tulimpeleka mtu polisi pale Mabatini.

Othman – Bajaj Driver, Makumbusho

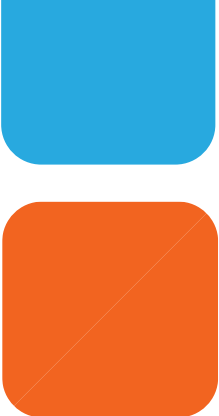
(Translation: "I always make sure that people stand in two lines facing away from each other. If I see someone turning towards another person or behaving inappropriately, my conductor and I make them get off the bus. One day, we even took someone to the police at Mabatini.")

Kituo hiki kinafikwa na watu zaidi ya 800 kwa siku poster hizi zitamuokoa binti na mama ambao hawezi kujitetea dhidi ya unyanyasaji wa kijinsia.

Othman, Daladala Driver, Makumbusho Bus Station

(Translation: "This bus station serves more than 800 people a day. These posters will help save a girl or a woman who cannot defend herself against gender-based harassment.")

2024 Highlights



EMPOWERING EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS: A WORKSHOP WITH JAMII IMPACT

On April 20th, in a collaborative effort with our esteemed partners at Jamii Impact, we orchestrated a meaningful workshop that brought together 40 nursery and primary school owners from Dar es Salaam and Pwani regions. The workshop aimed to empower these educational institutions by addressing critical aspects such as legal frameworks, adherence to governing laws for private schools, creating safe schools against Sexual Gender-Based Violence and access to microloans from Jamii Impact.

Our dedicated team had the privilege of delivering a presentation focused on combating SGBV within educational settings. By engaging directly with these school owners, we gained firsthand insights into the challenges they face. Their experiences were both enlightening and eye-opening, reinforcing the importance of our mission.

As an organization committed to creating safer and more supportive environments for children of all ages and genders, we recognize the direct impact we can make. Together with Jamii Impact, we continue to work towards a future where educational institutions thrive, students flourish, and safety remains paramount.

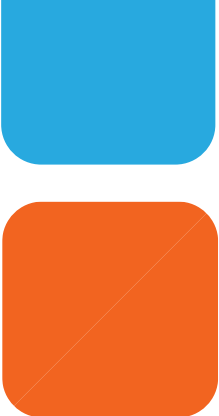
PARTICIPATION IN THE NAAIA-AHW MEETING IN MOROGORO

Our Programs Director, Sheilla Mathew, had the honor of representing our organization at the annual stakeholders meeting of the National Accelerated Action and Investment Agenda for Adolescent Health and Wellbeing (NAAIA-AHW) held in the Morogoro region. This opportunity is pivotal for our organization as we strive to create impactful interventions that drive positive change for adolescents and the communities we serve.

This significant opportunity not only allowed us to engage with key stakeholders but also positioned us to create impactful interventions that drive positive change for adolescents and the communities we serve. As we continue our mission, we recognize the pivotal role such gatherings play in shaping policies, fostering collaboration, and advancing the well-being of young people.



2024 Highlights



TRAINING BY THRDC

From July 31 to August 1, the Founder and CEO of OVAH Tanzania Modesta Joseph, had the opportunity to participate in training organized by THRDC, EAHRI, TCRF, and UDSOL for child rights advocates in Tanzania. These training sessions aimed to enhance the understanding of child rights advocates regarding legal and policy frameworks related to children's rights. The sessions focused on strengthening their ability to engage with national, regional, and international human rights systems related to children. Additionally, the training clarified the roles and limits of human rights defenders (HRDs) in promoting and protecting children's rights, identified and addressed challenges faced by child rights advocates.

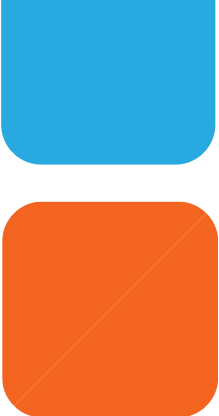
COMMEMORATION OF THE INTERNATIONAL DAY OF THE GIRL CHILD

On October 12, 2024, OVAH commemorated the International Day of the Girl under the global theme "Girls' Vision for the Future". We collaborated on this event with the Elimika na Mwajuma storytelling presentation and awards activity which brought together 25 students, grouped into teams of five(5) from the five schools that participated in the Elimika na Mwajuma storytelling competition, teachers, media and other invitees.

The day began with warm welcomes and excited icebreakers as students and guests arrived. The event featured a storytelling pitch, and a dialogue contributing to this year's International Day of the Girl Child theme, "Girls' Vision for the Future." The dialogue focused on an important question: "How Can Girls Lead the Fight Toward Gender Equality in Tanzania?" OVAH invited guest speakers, alongside two student representatives, Hadija Ulaya and Baraka Ramadhani, who brought their peers' perspectives into this critical discussion. Baraka, one of the few boys in attendance, reminded everyone that allies are essential in this fight towards ending SGBV.



2024 Highlights



The event had so many highlights but the one that sticks with us was one student performed a heartfelt song dedicated to OVAH, celebrating the work being done to empower girls. Not only that but also when Ms. Irene Marra, the day's moderator, invited everyone to write letters to their future selves. ***"Imagine yourself 10 years from now."*** she asked. It was amazing to see students and guests pour their dreams onto paper. Some shared their letters aloud, speaking of aspirations to become doctors, leaders, and change makers. The exercise was simple yet profound, leaving everyone with a renewed sense of purpose.

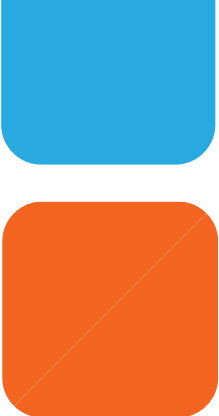
OVAH presented gift bags to the judges, panelists, and the Guest of Honor as a small gesture to show appreciation for their time and contributions. The day ended with smiles, hugs, and this day was a reminder that when we amplify the voices of girls and their allies, when we celebrate their visions for the future, we take a step closer to a world where equality isn't just a dream, but a reality

PARTICIPATION IN THE NAAIA-AHW FORUM IN DODOMA

From October 31st to November 1st, 2024, Modesta Joseph, Chief Executive and Teddy John. Program officer of OVAH Tanzania participated in The Adolescent Health Forum organized in Dodoma by the Ministry of Community Development, Gender, Women, and Special Groups, aimed at implementing adolescent-centered interventions across the country. Prior to this, OVAH was involved in planning meetings to discuss essential aspects of the Adolescent Health Forum.



2024 Highlights



During the forum, OVAH contributed to the panel discussion focused on the third intervention pillar: Preventing Physical, Sexual, and Emotional Violence. Modesta Joseph OVAH's Founder, shared effective strategies for strengthening protection systems to improve responses and support for adolescent victims of violence. She highlighted OVAH's school-based awareness programs and shared success stories from the "Teachers to Mentors" project which creates safe spaces in schools and fosters mentorship between teachers and students. Modesta also discussed ongoing challenges, such as underfunded protection systems, fragmented services, and untrained personnel, which lead to inadequate responses and re-victimization. She emphasized the need for continuous improvements, along with adolescent participation and co-creation, to drive meaningful change in the community.

The forum also provided a platform for adolescents and stakeholders to openly discuss the challenges they encounter and shared several recommendations to tackle them. Conclusively, stakeholders recommended ensuring a consistent project coordination across all levels, and establishing regular evaluation strategies to assess intervention effectiveness and consider a potential second phase NAIA-AHW strategy.

PARTICIPATION IN THE NAIA-AHW FORUM IN DODOMA

On November 22, 2024, OVAH Tanzania had a wall painting activity at Mashujaa Secondary School featuring Mwajuma, a symbolic character from Elimika na Mwajuma series representing girls, resilience and hope in the fight against sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV). This artwork serves not only as a visually compelling piece but also as an educational tool, promoting awareness and providing a mechanism for reporting Sexual and Gender Based Violence incidents. This painting was created to honor OVAH's volunteer Denise Alkadiri-Kohi who passed away earlier this year . Also it is designed to spark meaningful conversations and directly engage students and the broader community.



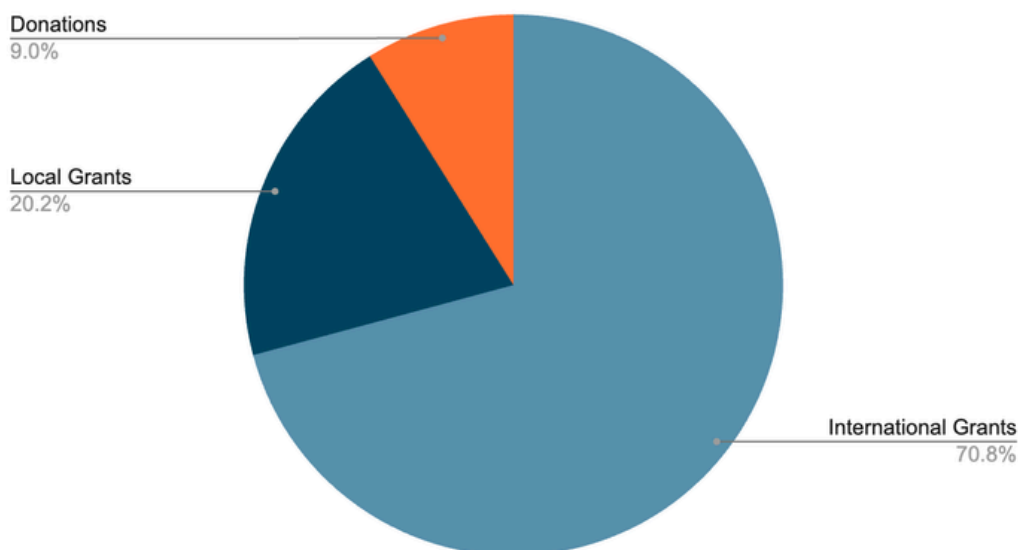
2024 Highlights

Ending Sexual and Gender Based Violence requires collective action, and through this painting , OVAH invites parents, teachers, local authority leaders (government), and community members in general to reflect on their roles in fostering a safer environment for all. The painting emphasizes the importance of reporting of SGBV cases . OVAH has 2 teachers from teachers to mentors who provide guidance and counseling to students who are victims or at risk to face SGBV. Through this paint we aim to see more students seeking help and break the culture of silence that often surrounds such issues.

During the unveiling of the painting, the OVAH team, along with teachers and students, pledged their support for ending SGBV by putting their colored palms in the wall. This collective commitment stands as a permanent testament that everyone has a role to play in this fight. Together we can create a community where schools are safe spaces for learning and growth.

FINANCIALS

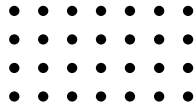
Raised Funds 2024



2024 Highlights

ORGANIZATION CHART





2024 Highlights

NEW COMMUNITIES AND CALITIONS



PARTNERSHIPS



SERENGETI
BYTES



Sema



SIKU 16 | ZA UANAHARAKATI
DHIDI YA UKATILI
WA KIJINSIA



ANNEX

[Link 1](#)

[Link 2](#)

[Link 3](#)

Important Links

Website:

www.ovah.or.tz

LinkedIn:

<https://www.linkedin.com/company/77138973/>

Instagram:

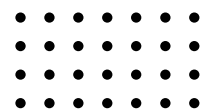
<https://www.instagram.com/ovahtanzania/>

Facebook:

<https://www.facebook.com/ovahtanzania>

YouTube:

<https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCj5a7QwAjEfLBkZRv44e7UA>



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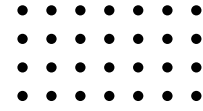
DISCLAIMER



**STOCK
ANALYSIS**

**BUSINESS
ASSETS**

Business Model



Annual Growth Rate

50%-85%



Ratio
8:10

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INTERNET OF THINGS

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ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

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